

From: Landslip Incident <landslipincident@ncc.nsw.gov.au>

Sent: 23 January 2026 14:17

Subject: Update to affected residents 23 January - New Lambton landslip incident

Dear residents,

As this is my first email for 2026 I will take a moment to say Happy New Year. I do hope over the Christmas and New Year period you were able to enjoy some time off with your families and friends. I also want to take a moment to acknowledge that in the coming months there will be a lot of activity as we reach some milestones. This can be a relief for some but for others it may cause some distress. Your health and wellbeing is important to me so please ensure that as we send updates, you do reach out if anything is not clear or you need to talk to someone.

Local Recovery Committee Update

The first meeting for 2026 was held on Wednesday 14 January. Thank you again to the resident representatives who attended. There were no significant updates from any of the agencies and we used the meeting as an opportunity to check in on the status of current recovery work including site conditions and security, progress of the geotechnical report, and other recovery efforts. All updates are included below in this email.

Site Conditions

Continued site monitoring from the data points on the road reserve at Russell Road indicates there has been no substantial movement since our last update, which is good news. Monitoring will continue and we will provide regular updates on the results. Hunter Water also continue to monitor and maintain their temporary services in place.

Site Security

At the Local Recovery Committee meeting, NSW Police confirmed that all recorded events to-date have been reviewed and over the holiday period eight (8) patrols were sent to the site. We have had no further reports of suspected squatters since NSW Police and City of Newcastle attended the site in December to do an inspection. We are still receiving reports of suspected fence tampering and trespassing. Please ensure you continue to report any incidents to NSW Police (either by phone or via their [Community Portal](#)) and that you keep a record of the assigned Event Number.

Geotechnical Investigation Report

The report is currently being finalised and on track for peer review by NSW Public Works and Transport for NSW. We will be in contact with you about how the report will be provided and our planned approach for a face-to-face briefing and a Q&A session. The report will be a significant milestone in this recovery effort. Once it is received we will be briefing Councillors, meeting again with the NSW Reconstruction Authority, and approaching elected representatives to advocate for support through the Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements (DRFA).

Advocacy with State Government

City of Newcastle CEO Jeremy Bath and Robert Dudgeon, along with myself, met with Charlestown MP Jodie Harrison prior to Christmas to provide an update on the New Lambton landslip. At this meeting it was reiterated that State Government support is still needed. The security issues were raised and Ms Harrison committed to following up with NSW Police to ensure the New Lambton site continues to receive the appropriate response.

It was also raised with Ms Harrison that a number of families are facing increasing financial pressures, particularly for those whose insurance rental support will cease from May onwards, and those who are still paying mortgages and waiting on insurance outcomes.

I will be contacting each of you to request information again about your circumstances, specifically what rental costs you will incur post May to secure temporary housing. This will ensure we have evidence to support our request to the State Government for a possible support package.

Rate Rebate

City of Newcastle's rates team are currently finalising the process for the rates rebate. We will send you the relevant information as soon as we receive it. Just a reminder though that before you can submit your application all rates must be paid. If you have any questions about your current rates notice or need to check that you have no outstanding balance please contact City of Newcastle's Customer Service team on (02) 4974 2000 or by completing the [Rates Enquiry Form](#) online.

Waste Levy Exemptions

Discussions are continuing with the EPA regarding the extension of the waste levy exemption. We are aware some people are looking into demolition and that contractors have also asked about this fee exemption in order to provide their quotes. Once we have a response from the EPA we will send out an update.

Central Coast Recovery

We acknowledge there has also been several disasters in other areas over the past few weeks and the devastating impact these have had on those communities. The recent bushfires in Koolewong last month resulted in 16 homes being destroyed and another 23 being damaged. Given the location of those homes, being on slopes with difficult access and containing asbestos materials, we understand discussions are now taking place about what support will be made available. We believe this community is also experiencing issues due to insurance shortfalls and excessive demolition/waste removal costs, much similar circumstances to the New Lambton Landslip. We will follow this recovery closely in the event support packages become available for those circumstances.

As we move into the next few weeks I anticipate there will be more frequent communication and, as always, I encourage you to reach out to me if you have any questions or concerns. I can be contacted at landslipincident@ncc.nsw.gov.au or on my mobile 0409 710 878.

Melissa Gore

Local Recovery Coordinator

Landslip Incident | City of Newcastle

E: landslipincident@ncc.nsw.gov.au | T: +61249742000

City of Newcastle acknowledges the Traditional Custodians of the land

of the Newcastle LGA, the Awabakal and Worimi peoples.